VECTOR HUMANITIES

A Vector Book Specimen

ベクトル人文学

書物の設計

見本

Vector Humanities

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Conventions for typesetting translations and editions

書物の設計

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A Vector Book Specimen. The design is the one first made for the vector translation of Kuki Shūzō's 偶然性の問題 (*The Problem of Contingency*, 1935).

Numbers in the outer margin give the pages of a notional source edition. Footnotes are the translator's; insertions into the source text are set in tortoise-shell brackets, 〔 〕 .

Specimen edition, 2026

Released under the GNU General Public License, version 3 or later, with the Vector Book source.
The Japanese verse is Matsuo Bashō's and the Greek is Heraclitus as transmitted by Heraclitus Homericus; both are in the public domain. The figure was drawn for this specimen.

Typeset in EB Garamond 12, Gentium Book Plus and Hiragino Mincho ProN with Vector Book.
Source files: `examples/specimen/` in the Vector Book repository.

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Preface

Vector Book typesets the editions and translations of Vector Humanities. It takes a folder of Markdown files, one per section, and a short description of the book in `book.toml`, and produces a print-ready PDF through Pandoc and Typst. The design is the one made for the vector translation of Kuki Shūzō's 偶然性の問題 (*The Problem of Contingency*, 1935): Royal octavo, EB Garamond, centred small-capital headings, and the pages of the source edition in the outer margin.

The tool collects what that book needed. Every convention in this specimen answers to a problem met in building it: tables that could not break across pages and overprinted the glossary, notes in figure captions that were lost in conversion, characters missing from the font stack, a key term split by hyphenation at the end of a line. Each is now handled by the build rather than by hand.

This specimen is built from the files in `examples/specimen/`. Read them beside the pages they make.

CHAPTER 1

Conventions of the Text

凡例

Page Markers

A marker in square brackets, such as the one that opens this paragraph in the source file, records where a page of the source edition begins. 1 The build sets it as a small number in the outer margin, beside the line where the page begins, so that a reader can find any passage in the original.[1] A second pattern, here an image number, is removed from the book while it stays in the files for checking against the page images.

Markers may fall anywhere in a paragraph. This sentence is long enough to run on across the measure, and the marker that follows it begins the second page of the notional source, partway through a line of the translation. 2 Notes keep their markers out of the margin: a marker inside a note definition is dropped.

Notes and Insertions

Every note is the translator's and begins "Tr.". The author's own references stay in the text as printed, for example (Kant, *KrV*, B 106). Where the translator adds words the source does not have, they stand in tortoise-shell brackets: the encounter 〔of two independent series〕 is the core of the contingent.[2] Nothing the translator adds sits unmarked in the author's sentences.

Notes restart at 1 with each chapter. They sit at the foot of the page in a smaller size, set off by a short rule.

Languages

The font stack covers Latin with its diacritics (Kuki Shūzō, Gūzensei no mondai, Hegel's *Vermittlung*), Japanese (偶然性の問題), Greek (ποταμοῖς

[1] Tr. In a translation from page images the marker gives the printed page; the image number goes beside it in the files and is stripped from the book.

[2] Tr. Insertions in 〔 〕 follow the Japanese editorial convention for words added by an editor or quoter.

τοῖς αὐτοῖς ἐμβαίνομέν τε καὶ οὐκ ἐμβαίνομεν), and the signs of logic (∀x ∃y, p → q, ¬(p ∧ q)). Each script falls through the stack to the first font that has it. `vbook sweep` sets every distinct character in the book on a test page and reports any that reach a font outside the stack or no font at all.

Some words should never break across a line. The configuration protects them by name: contingency and contingencies are never hyphenated in this book.

Verse

3 Verse goes in a note with its original as printed and a close translation; the text keeps the English.

> The old pond: a frog jumps in, the sound of water.[3]

Where verse must stand in the text, a line block keeps its lines:

> The old pond,
> a frog jumps in,
> the sound of water.

Quotation

> We step and do not step into the same rivers; we are and are not.[4]

[3] Tr. 古池や蛙飛びこむ水の音 (*furuike ya / kawazu tobikomu / mizu no oto*). Matsuo Bashō, 1686.

[4] Tr. ποταμοῖς τοῖς αὐτοῖς ἐμβαίνομέν τε καὶ οὐκ ἐμβαίνομεν, εἶμέν τε καὶ οὐκ εἶμεν. Heraclitus, fragment B 49a (Diels-Kranz).

CHAPTER 2

Figures, Schemes and Tables

図と表

Figures

A figure is an image on its own line followed by a caption paragraph that begins with its bold number. The image is set at the size it had in the source, from its pixel width and the resolution given in the configuration, and never wider than the text. Glosses from `figures/overlays.json` are laid over its labels in small italic, placed by fractions of the image's width and height. Anything after "Labels:" in the caption is set as a key beneath the figure, and a note in the caption stays in the text without reaching the List of Figures. 4

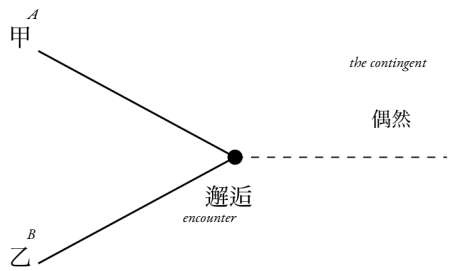


Figure 1. Two independent series meeting at a point, drawn for this specimen.[1]

Labels: 甲 A; 乙 B; 邂逅 encounter; 偶然 the contingent.

Schemes

A scheme joins a head to its branches with a brace. It is written as a fenced block with the class `scheme`: the first paragraph is the head, the list gives the branches, and text in a span with the class `tag` is set small and grey.

[1] Tr. Figures cropped from page images keep the marks of earlier readers, which are recorded in the figure manifest.

Contingency = *the encounter* (*kaikō*) { (of two series) hypothetical contingency; (of the one and the other) disjunctive contingency

Tables

Tables are set without a frame, with a rule under the header, and they break across pages with the header repeated. Column widths follow the length of their contents, so that a column of long entries does not crush its neighbours.

In the section file	In the book	Notes
`# Title {num="Chapter 1" orig="凡例"}`	Chapter opening on a recto: number, title, original title	`run` gives a shorter running head
`[p. 12]`	12 in the outer margin	Pattern set in `markers.page`
`[^c1-2]: Tr. …`	Footnote, numbered from 1 in each chapter	Markers inside notes are dropped
`〔 〕`	Set as written	For every word the translator adds to the source
`![Figure 1](figures/x.png)` and a `**Figure 1.**` paragraph	Figure at source size with glosses, caption, key	Glosses from `overlays.json`
`::: scheme`	Head and branches joined by a brace	Spans `{.tag}` set small
A pipe table	Table that breaks across pages	Widths follow content
`glossary.csv`	The last chapter, as a table	Columns chosen in `book.toml`

APPENDIX A

Building a Book

The Files

A book is a folder. `book.toml` describes it; `front/`, `text/` and `back/` hold the section files, joined in filename order; `figures/` holds the images and `overlays.json`; `glossary.csv` is the glossary, set as the book's last chapter. The book is written to the path given as `output`.

The Build

`vbook build` assembles the section files, turns page markers into margin numbers, and passes the result through Pandoc with the Vector Book filter, which writes chapters, figures, schemes and table widths as Typst. Typst then sets the book with the chosen template and covers. Run `vbook check` after each build: it compares the notes and figures set with those in the sources and reports missing glyphs.

Before the First Chapter

Build the book from the first merged chapter and rebuild after every merge. Tables that cannot break, notes lost from captions, and missing characters all show in a one-chapter book.

Glossary

Source	Reading	English	Notes
偶然性	gūzensei	contingency	
必然性	hitsuzensei	necessity	
邂逅	kaikō	encounter	
古池	furuike	old pond	Bashō
ποταμός	potamos	river	Heraclitus
Vermittlung		mediation	

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Page left deliberately blank

The translator directs. The agents draft, check and assemble.

Vector Translation, Method

This specimen sets out the conventions Vector Book reads from Markdown: chapters with their original titles, source page numbers in the margin, translator's notes, insertions in tortoise-shell brackets, verse with its original in a note, figures with English glosses over their labels, schemes, tables that break across pages, and a glossary built from the project's glossary file.

The same files that make this book make any other: write the text in section files, describe the book in `book.toml`, and run `vbook build`.

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